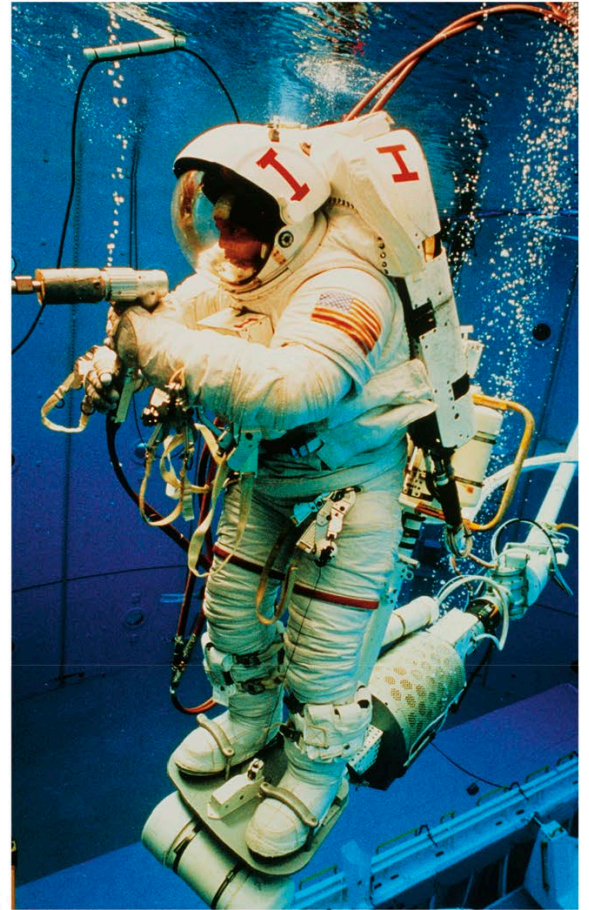


Astronaut in training

Astronauts do not just climb into a spacecraft and zip off into space – they need months of study and training first. They have to be in peak physical condition, and some astronauts claim their training is much harder than any mission.

Whatever it takes

Astronauts train for all sorts of situations. When necessary, they use real aircraft, equipment simulators, virtual reality systems, and computer simulations. A simulator imitates a situation or environment that an astronaut can be trained in before experiencing the real environment.



Underwater training

Floating in water is very much like floating in space, so astronauts use special water tanks to train for space walks. One NASA tank can hold full-size modules of the International Space Station.

During an exercise, five NASA astronauts-in-training pull an “injured” crewmate to safety after a simulated parachute jump.

